

Siobhan Clemente, PhD

NSF Postdoctoral Research Fellow
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Research Experience

- | | |
|---------------------|--|
| 2025-current | NSF Postdoctoral Research Fellow
Virginia Tech |
| 2019-25 | PhD Dissertation, Organismic and Evolutionary Biology
University of Massachusetts Amherst |
| 2017-19 | Research Assistant, Horticulture Lab
University of Guam |
| 2018 | Undergraduate Researcher, Harvard Forest
Harvard University |
| 2017 | Undergraduate Researcher, Organization for Tropical Studies
La Selva Biological Station, Costa Rica |

Education

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|-------------|---|
| 2025 | Ph.D., Organismic and Evolutionary Biology
University of Massachusetts Amherst |
| 2019 | B.S. Biology (summa cum laude)
University of Guam |

Courses Taught

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| 2024-25 | Laboratory Instructor, UMass Amherst
Animal Behavior |
| 2023 | Instructor, UMass Amherst
"All for One, One for All:
Cooperative Behavior in the Animal Kingdom" |

Courses Taught (cont'd)

2021	Instructor, UMass Amherst "Teamwork Makes the Dreamwork: An Exploration of Animal Social Behavior"
2018-19	Teaching Assistant, Univ. of Guam Laboratory Techniques in Organic Chemistry (CH312)

Grants and Fellowships

2024	Postdoctoral Research Fellowship in Biology (\$80,000 yearly) National Science Foundation
2022	Bigelow Memorial Fellowship in Plant Biology (\$3,000) University of Massachusetts
2021	Centennial Pollinator Fellowship (\$2,500) Garden Club of America/Pollinator Partnership
2020-23	Graduate Research Fellowship (\$46,000 yearly) National Science Foundation
2020	Lotta Crabtree Fellowship (\$5,000) University of Massachusetts Amherst
2020	Pre-dissertation Grant (\$1,000) University of Massachusetts Amherst
2019, 2023	Spaulding-Smith Fellowship (\$25,000 yearly) University of Massachusetts

Peer-Reviewed Publications

In Prep

[9] **Clemente, S.R.**, Theis, N., Sykes, L.S, Vaidheeswaran, S.R., and Adler, L.S. Differential medicinal effects of *Ocimum basilicum* varieites on a bumble bee parasite: Implications for pollinator self-medication. Planning to submit to *Ecology*.

In Review

[8] **Clemente, S.R.**, Theis, N., and Adler, L.S. Intraspecific floral chemical variation in *Ocimum basilicum* cultivars. In review at *Phytochemistry*.

Published

[7] Aguirre, L.A., Theis, N., Pak, J., Abbot, S., **Clemente, S.R.**, and Adler, L.S. Effects of leaf herbivory on floral trait correlations and scent composition in *Asclepias syriaca*. (2025). *Journal of Chemical Ecology*, 51(103).

DOI: [10.1007/s10886-025-01654-7](https://doi.org/10.1007/s10886-025-01654-7)

[6] **Clemente, S.R.**, Adler, L.S., Salminen, J.P., Engström, M.T., Baert, N., McArt, S.H. Chemical, morphological, and phenological traits of blueberry cultivars predict susceptibility to a pollinator-vectored fungal pathogen (2025). *Journal of Chemical Ecology*, 51(4): 1-15.

DOI: [10.1007/s10886-025-01621-2](https://doi.org/10.1007/s10886-025-01621-2)

[5] **Clemente, S.R.** and Adler, L.S. (2022). What is pollination and what are pollinators in agriculture? In P. Kevan & S.W. Chan (Eds.), *Promoting pollination and pollinators in farming*. Burleigh Dodds Science Publishing.

[4] Marutani, M. and **Clemente, S.R.** Compost-based growing media improved yield of leafy lettuce in pot culture (2021). *Agronomy*, 11(9): 1762.

DOI:[10.3390/agronomy11091762](https://doi.org/10.3390/agronomy11091762)

[3] **Clemente, S.R.** and Whitehead, S.R. Ant seed removal in a non-myrmecochorus Neotropical shrub: Implications for seed dispersal (2019). *Biotropica*, 52(1): 90-100.

DOI:[10.1111/btp.12728](https://doi.org/10.1111/btp.12728)

Other Publications

[2] **Clemente, S.R.** and Marutani, M. Growing roselle (*Hibiscus sabdariffa*) on Guam. University of Guam Cooperative Extension, FPP-29. 10p.

[1] Tuquero, J., **Clemente, S.R.**, and Marutani, M. 2017. Growing lettuce on Guam. University of Guam Cooperative Extension, FPP-04. 7p.

Honors and Awards

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|-------------|--|
| 2024 | People's Choice Award & Runner Up, UMass Amherst 3 Minute Thesis Competition (Watch talk here: https://youtu.be/QcWqF-ujDEY?si=q9TnNmmFh16RqjSZ) |
| 2022 | Finalist, UMass Amherst 3 Minute Thesis Competition (Watch talk here: https://youtu.be/9nmXPjibK9A) |
| 2020 | Pre-doctoral Fellowship (offered fellowship, declined)
Ford Foundation |
| 2019 | Graduate Research Fellowship, Honorable Mention
National Science Foundation |

Student Advising

- 2025** **Reese Baxter**, U. of Mass. Amherst (independent research)
"Concentrations of secondary metabolites in basil nectar influence parasite resistance in *Bombus impatiens*"
- 2023** **Elizabeth Sykes**, U. of Mass. Amherst (independent research)
"Effects of chemical composition of *Ocimum basilicum* varieties on *Crithidia bombi* infection in *Bombus impatiens*"
- 2022** **Srinath Vaidheeswaran**, U. of Mass. Amherst (independent research)
"Transmission dynamics of a bumble bee parasite on a
- 2022** **Joseph Zeno**, Elms College (independent research)
"Floral scent of basil may affect *Crithidia* parasitism of the common eastern bumble bee, *Bombus impatiens*"
- 2019** **Merry Remetira**, U. of Guam (NIH-NIDDK STEP-UP intern)
"Efficacy of hot pepper (*Capsicum spp.*) extracts as a pesticide on invasive coconut rhinoceros beetles (*Oryctes rhinoceros*)

Professional Service and Outreach

- 2022-24** Outreach Organizing Member
Afterschool Program in Ecology and Evolution (aka Nature Club)
Girls, Inc. of the Valley
- 2019-23** Outreach Committee Chairperson
Graduate Program in Organismic & Evolutionary Biology
University of Massachusetts Amherst
- 2019-21** Participant, Summer Seminars
Eureka! Summer Program
Girls, Inc. of the Valley
- 2019-21** Organizing Committee
Life Science Café
University of Massachusetts Amherst
- 2018-19** Outreach Coordinator
Guam Plant Extinction Prevention Program
- 2017** Sea Turtle Outreach Intern
University of Guam Sea Grant

References

Lynn S. Adler, Ph.D.

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Elizabeth Jakob, Ph.D.

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Professor, Department of Biology
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Haldre S. Rogers, Ph.D.

Professor, Department of Biological Sciences
Virginia Tech
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Nina Theis, Ph.D.

Professor, Natural Sciences, Mathematics, and Technology Division
Elms College
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